

Royal University of Phnom Penh
Institute of Foreign Languages
Department of English

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Class: A3.5

Reading Log (W1-W15)

The title of what u read	Date	What's the story about? (summarize)	New Vocabulary	Opinion
OpenAI Launches GPT-5.5	August 2026	OpenAI officially introduced GPT-5.5, the latest version of its artificial intelligence model. This update improves the chatbot's ability to reason, write, solve coding problems, and answer questions more accurately. Compared to previous versions, GPT-5.5 is better at understanding complex instructions and producing more natural conversations. It is designed to help students, professionals, and businesses complete tasks more efficiently while reducing incorrect or misleading responses. Developers can also integrate the model into their own applications, making AI technology more accessible for different industries around the world.	Accessible (adj): easy to use or obtain.	I think GPT-5.5 is an important improvement because artificial intelligence has become part of many people's daily lives. It can help students understand difficult lessons, support teachers in preparing materials, and save time for workers. However, AI should be used as a tool instead of replacing human thinking. Users should still verify important information before trusting it completely. Overall, I believe GPT-5.5 will continue to make learning and working more convenient if people use it responsibly.

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NASA Continues Preparing for Artemis Moon Mission	July 2026	NASA continues making progress on the Artemis program, which aims to send astronauts back to the Moon after more than fifty years. Engineers are carefully testing the Orion spacecraft, the Space Launch System rocket, and other important equipment to make sure every mission is safe. Besides landing astronauts on the Moon, NASA hopes to build a long-term lunar base that can support scientific research. The knowledge gained from these missions will also help prepare future human exploration of Mars and other destinations in deep space.	Exploration (n): the act of traveling to discover new places or information.	I believe the Artemis program is one of the most exciting scientific projects today. Exploring the Moon will help scientists learn more about space while developing new technologies that may benefit life on Earth. Although space missions require a large amount of money, they often lead to inventions that improve communication, medicine, and engineering. I hope the mission succeeds because it will inspire young people to study science and contribute to future space discoveries.
Countries Increase Efforts to Reduce Plastic Pollution	June 2026	Many countries are introducing stronger policies to reduce plastic pollution and protect the environment. Governments are encouraging people to recycle more, use reusable shopping bags, and reduce single-use plastic products. Some businesses have also started using environmentally friendly packaging to reduce waste. Environmental organizations believe these actions can help protect oceans, rivers, and wildlife from harmful plastic waste. Although progress has been made, experts say that cooperation between governments, companies, and individuals is still necessary to achieve long-term environmental improvements.	Reusable (adj): able to be used again many times.	I strongly support these efforts because plastic pollution has become a serious global problem. Every year, large amounts of plastic enter rivers and oceans, causing damage to marine animals and ecosystems. I believe everyone should play a role in reducing plastic waste by recycling and choosing reusable products whenever possible. Governments should also continue educating the public about environmental protection. If people work together, future generations can enjoy a cleaner and healthier environment.

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WHO Encourages Better Mental Health Support	May 2026	The World Health Organization continues encouraging governments to improve mental health services around the world. Many awareness campaigns focus on reducing discrimination, helping people recognize signs of depression and anxiety, and making professional support easier to access. Experts explain that mental health problems can affect anyone regardless of age or background. Early treatment and community support can improve recovery and reduce the negative impact on individuals and families. The organization believes mental health should receive the same attention as physical health.	Awareness (n): knowledge or understanding about a situation or issue.	I think mental health is an important topic that deserves more public attention. Many people are afraid to ask for help because they worry about being judged by others. Raising awareness can encourage people to seek treatment earlier and support friends or family members who may be struggling. Schools and workplaces should also provide better mental health education and counseling services. In my opinion, caring for mental health is just as important as maintaining physical health.
Electric Vehicle Sales Continue to Grow Worldwide	April 2026	Electric vehicles are becoming more popular as governments and car manufacturers continue investing in cleaner transportation. Many new models now offer longer driving ranges, faster charging times, and lower maintenance costs than earlier versions. Several countries also provide financial incentives to encourage people to buy electric cars instead of gasoline-powered vehicles. Experts believe this transition can reduce air pollution and greenhouse gas emissions. However, expanding charging infrastructure remains one of the biggest challenges for the industry.	Infrastructure (n): the basic systems and facilities needed for a country or organization to operate.	I believe electric vehicles are an important step toward protecting the environment. As technology continues improving, more people will likely choose electric cars because they are cleaner and more efficient. However, governments should build more charging stations so drivers can travel conveniently over long distances. Companies should also focus on recycling used batteries to reduce environmental impact. Overall, I think electric vehicles will become an important part of future transportation.

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Scientists Discover New Species in the Deep Ocean	March 2026	Marine scientists recently discovered several previously unknown species during a deep-sea research expedition. Using advanced underwater technology, researchers explored areas of the ocean that had never been carefully studied before. The discovery included unusual fish, corals, and other sea creatures that have adapted to survive under extreme conditions. Scientists believe these findings will improve our understanding of marine biodiversity and the evolution of life in deep oceans. They also emphasize the importance of protecting these fragile ecosystems from pollution and climate change.	Biodiversity (n): the variety of living plants and animals in an environment.	I think discoveries like this remind us that there is still much to learn about our planet. Many parts of the ocean remain unexplored, and new species continue to surprise scientists. Learning about marine life can help researchers protect endangered ecosystems and better understand how nature works. I hope governments continue supporting scientific research because protecting ocean biodiversity will benefit both wildlife and future generations of people.
United Nations Calls for Stronger Climate Action	February 2026	The United Nations has urged countries to strengthen their efforts in addressing climate change. During international meetings, world leaders discussed reducing greenhouse gas emissions, investing in renewable energy, and improving cooperation between developed and developing nations. Scientists warn that rising global temperatures could increase extreme weather events, including floods, droughts, and heatwaves. The UN believes immediate action is necessary to reduce environmental damage and protect future generations from the long-term effects of climate change.	Renewable (adj): naturally replaced and able to be used repeatedly.	I agree that climate change is one of the biggest challenges facing the world today. Every country should contribute by reducing pollution and investing in clean energy sources. Individuals can also make a difference by saving electricity, recycling, and using public transportation whenever possible. Although solving climate change will take many years, taking action now is much better than waiting until the problem becomes even more serious.

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Scientists Develop More Efficient Solar Panels	January 2026	Researchers have developed a new generation of solar panels that can produce more electricity from the same amount of sunlight. The improved technology increases energy efficiency while lowering production costs, making solar power more affordable for homes and businesses. Scientists believe these advancements will encourage more countries to invest in renewable energy and reduce their dependence on fossil fuels. Although additional testing is still needed, experts are optimistic that these solar panels will contribute to a cleaner and more sustainable future.	Efficient (adj): working well without wasting time, energy, or resources.	I think improving solar panel technology is excellent news because renewable energy plays an important role in protecting the environment. As solar power becomes more affordable, more families and businesses will be able to reduce their electricity costs while producing clean energy. Governments should continue supporting renewable energy projects and encourage people to install solar panels whenever possible. In my opinion, investing in clean energy today will create a healthier and more sustainable world for future generations.
Apple Introduces New iPhone Features	September 2025	Apple announced its latest iPhone with several new features designed to improve user experience. The new model includes a faster processor, a more advanced camera system, better battery performance, and improved security features. Apple also introduced software updates that make multitasking smoother and allow users to customize their devices more easily. During the launch event, the company emphasized that the new technology was created to make everyday tasks faster and more convenient. These improvements continue Apple's effort to stay competitive in the global smartphone market.	Customize (v): to change something so it suits a person's needs or preferences.	I think Apple's latest improvements will attract many customers because smartphones have become an important part of everyday life. Better cameras, faster performance, and stronger security are useful for students, workers, and content creators. However, I also think Apple should consider making its products more affordable since many people cannot easily buy the newest models. Overall, I believe the new iPhone offers meaningful improvements, but the high price may still prevent some people from upgrading.

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Google Expands AI Search Features	October 2025	Google has expanded its AI-powered search features to provide users with faster and more detailed answers. Instead of showing only website links, the new system can summarize information from different sources and present it in an easier-to-read format. The company believes this will help users find information more efficiently while reducing the time spent searching online. Google also stated that it is continuing to improve the accuracy of AI-generated responses while encouraging users to verify information from trusted sources.	Efficiently (adv): in a way that saves time and effort.	I believe AI-powered search is a useful development because it helps people find information much faster than traditional searching. Students, researchers, and professionals can save time when studying or completing projects. However, I think users should not depend entirely on AI summaries because mistakes can still happen. Reading the original sources is important, especially when researching academic or professional topics. Overall, I see AI search as a helpful tool, but critical thinking remains necessary.
Coral Reef Restoration Projects Expand Worldwide	November 2025	Scientists and environmental organizations are expanding coral reef restoration projects in different parts of the world. These programs involve planting healthy coral, reducing water pollution, and protecting marine habitats from human activities. Coral reefs are home to thousands of marine species and play an important role in maintaining healthy ocean ecosystems. Researchers hope these restoration efforts will slow the loss of coral caused by climate change, rising ocean temperatures, and pollution while helping marine life recover over time.	Habitat (n): the natural environment where plants or animals live.	I think coral reef restoration is extremely important because coral reefs support many kinds of marine animals and protect coastal communities. If reefs continue disappearing, many ocean species could lose their homes and food sources. Governments, businesses, and individuals should work together to reduce pollution and protect marine environments. Although restoring damaged reefs takes many years, every successful project gives hope that these valuable ecosystems can recover in the future.

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UNESCO Adds More World Heritage Sites	December 2025	UNESCO announced several new additions to its World Heritage List, recognizing places with outstanding cultural, historical, and natural value. These sites include ancient buildings, national parks, and important archaeological locations from different countries. Being added to the World Heritage List helps increase international recognition while encouraging governments to protect these valuable places. UNESCO hopes that preserving these sites will allow future generations to learn more about human history, culture, and the natural world.	Preserve (v): to protect something from damage or destruction.	I believe protecting World Heritage Sites is very important because they represent the history and culture of different civilizations. These places allow people to understand how societies developed throughout history while promoting tourism and education. Governments should continue investing in preservation projects to prevent damage caused by pollution, natural disasters, or human activities. In my opinion, protecting these sites is a responsibility shared by the entire world because they belong to our common heritage.
Researchers Improve Early Cancer Detection	March 2026	Scientists have developed new medical technology that may improve the early detection of certain types of cancer. The new methods use advanced laboratory testing and artificial intelligence to identify signs of disease before symptoms become severe. Researchers believe earlier diagnosis can increase the success of treatment and improve survival rates for many patients. Although additional clinical testing is still required, the results are encouraging and may lead to better healthcare in the future.	Diagnosis (n): the identification of a disease or medical condition.	I think this research is very encouraging because early detection can save many lives. When diseases are discovered at an early stage, doctors usually have more treatment options and patients have a better chance of recovery. Governments should continue supporting medical research because new technologies can improve healthcare for everyone. Although more studies are still needed, I hope these discoveries will become widely available and benefit patients around the world.

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Schools Continue Using AI to Support Learning	April 2026	Many schools and universities are continuing to explore how artificial intelligence can support teaching and learning. AI tools help students understand difficult concepts, practice languages, receive personalized feedback, and organize their study materials more effectively. Teachers also use AI to prepare lesson plans and create learning activities. At the same time, educators remind students that AI should support learning rather than replace independent thinking, creativity, and academic honesty.	Personalized (adj): designed to meet the needs of a particular person.	I think AI can become a valuable learning assistant when students use it responsibly. It can explain difficult topics, provide additional practice, and help learners become more confident. However, students should avoid copying AI-generated answers without understanding the content. Education is about developing knowledge and critical thinking, not simply completing assignments. In my opinion, AI should be treated as a helpful study partner instead of replacing a student's own effort.
SpaceX Conducts Another Starship Test Flight	May 2026	SpaceX carried out another Starship test flight as part of its long-term plan to develop spacecraft capable of traveling to the Moon and Mars. During the test, engineers collected valuable information about the vehicle's performance, allowing them to improve future designs and solve technical problems. Although space testing is often challenging, every mission provides important lessons that bring scientists closer to achieving reliable deep-space transportation. The company continues working toward making human space exploration more practical.	Prototype (n): the first version of something used for testing.	I believe repeated testing is necessary because space exploration involves many risks and requires extremely high safety standards. Even when a test does not go perfectly, scientists and engineers gain useful information that helps improve future missions. I admire the determination of space agencies and private companies that continue developing new technology despite challenges. Their work may one day allow humans to travel farther into space than ever before.